Annual Report

This report summarises the financial performance of the company during the last fiscal year and outlines the priorities for the coming twelve months. It is intended for shareholders and the executive board.

Market overview

The overall market grew by four percent, driven mainly by strong demand in the industrial segment. Consumer demand remained flat, and competitors reacted with aggressive discounts in the second half of the year.

Our own share of the market increased slightly. Management attributes this result to the new product line and to a more focused sales organisation.

Regional results

Europe delivered the highest revenue growth of all regions, while North America contributed the largest absolute profit. Asia remains a long term investment with modest short term returns.

Outlook

For the coming year we expect stable growth and continued investment in automation. The board proposes an unchanged dividend.